

ANA DONATE

Ph.D. Candidate | Centre for Alcohol and Drug Research, Aarhus University

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Candidate | 2023–present

Centre for Alcohol and Drug Research, Department of Psychology and Behavioural Sciences, Aarhus University, Denmark

Supervisor: Prof. Kristine Rømer Thomsen; Co-supervisor: Dr. Janna Cousijn

M.Sc. in Psychobiology | 2019–2021

Center for Research on Health and Substance Use, Federal University of São Paulo (UNIFESP), Brazil

Specialization in Cognitive Behavioral Therapy | 2015–2016

Paulista College of Social Service of São Caetano do Sul, Brazil (*Licensed CBT Therapist*)

B.A. in Psychology | 2010–2015

Mackenzie Presbyterian University, São Paulo, Brazil

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Visiting Researcher | 2024—present

NofA Lab, Erasmus University Rotterdam, Netherlands

- Part of an international collaboration designing an ESM-based study to capture real-time associations between sleep and cannabis use across continents.

Graduate Researcher (M.Sc. Student) | 2019—2021

Center for Health and Substance Use, Federal University of São Paulo, Brazil

Supervisor: Prof. Ana Regina Noto, Ph.D.

- Designed and conducted a randomized controlled trial of Mindfulness-Based Relapse Prevention (MBRP) for inpatients with substance use disorders.
- Investigated effects of MBRP on impulsivity, decision-making, inhibitory control, and implicit associations.

Research Intern | 2017—2019

Center for Health and Substance Use, Federal University of São Paulo, Brazil

Supervisor: Prof. Ana Regina Noto, Ph.D.

- Gained training in clinical trial procedures for addiction studies.
- Completed professional certification for MBRP instructors (introductory to advanced modules).

Undergraduate Researcher | 2012—2015

Social and Cognitive Neuroscience Laboratory, Mackenzie Presbyterian University, Brazil

Supervisor: Prof. Paulo Sérgio Boggio, Ph.D.

- **2014–2015** | Project: Investigated the role of the ventrolateral prefrontal cortex (vlPFC) in social exclusion using tDCS, psychophysiology, and emotional measures.
- **2013–2014** | Project: Right dorsolateral prefrontal cortex (dlPFC) and emotion regulation after social exclusion (tDCS study).
- **2012–2013** | Project: Investigated ostracism in social virtual interaction task.

TEACHING

Course Development

Research Methods and Treatment Approaches for Substance Use Disorders | 2025

Aarhus University Summer School — Invited to develop course content and materials.

Substance Use, Recovery, and Interventions (multiple modules: Motivational Interviewing, Relapse Prevention, CBT, MBRP, Brief Assessments, Research Methods) | 2024

Aarhus University Summer School — Invited to develop course content and materials.

Mindfulness-Based Relapse Prevention; Brief Interventions and Assessment for SUDs | 2023

Aarhus University Summer School — Invited to develop course content and materials.

Mindfulness, Emotion Regulation and Impulsivity; Neurophysiology of Emotions | 2020

Plenativamente Institute for Mindfulness, Brazil (Postgraduate).

Mindfulness and Thoughts; Psychobiology of Addiction | 2018–2017

Mindfulness-Based Relapse Prevention – Brazil.

Guest Lectures & Teaching

Substance Use, Recovery, and Research Methods (Undergraduate courses) | 2024

Department of Psychology, Aarhus University, Denmark.

Tutor, Research Methods (SPSS for MSc students) | 2023

Department of Psychology, Aarhus University, Denmark.

Mindfulness-Based Relapse Prevention; Brief Interventions for Substance Use (Undergraduate) | 2023

Aarhus University Summer School.

Mindfulness, Emotion Regulation and Impulsivity; Neurophysiology of Emotions | 2020

Plenativamente Institute for Mindfulness, Brazil (Postgraduate).

Scientific Evidence of MBRP (Postgraduate) | 2019

Federal University of São Paulo, Brazil.

Mindfulness and Thoughts (Undergraduate) | 2018

Federal University of São Paulo, Brazil.

Psychobiology of Addiction (Undergraduate) | 2017

Psychobiology Summer School, Federal University of São Paulo, Brazil.

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, & SCHOLARSHIPS

2024	Research Abroad Grant, Familien Hede Nielsens Foundation (<i>DKK 7,500</i>)
2024	Research Abroad Grant, Aarhus University
2023	Denmark's Mental Health Day Award
2023	Well-being Promotion Grant, Aarhus University (<i>DKK 10,000</i>)
2023	Research Project Grant, Aarhus University (<i>DKK 30,000</i>)

2023–2026 | Full PhD Scholarship, Aarhus University (BSS)
 2019 | Research Grant (AUD), FAPESP, Brazil
 2016 | Fellowship, Center of Cognitive Therapy Veda
 2012–2015 | Undergraduate Fellowships & Grants, FAPESP & Mackenzie Presbyterian Institute
 2012 | Research Grant (Neuromodulation), CNPq, Brazil
 2010–2015 | Full Undergraduate Scholarship (PROUNI), Brazilian Government

PROFESSIONAL ROLES AND SERVICE

Mentor for incoming PhD student, Department of Psychology and Behavioural Sciences | 2025–present

Aarhus University, Denmark

Researcher, Research Committee | 2024–present

Ministry of Justice and Public Safety, Brazil

Mentee, Next-Gen Psych Scholars Program | 2022

University of Minnesota, USA

Member, Evidence-Based Psychology Association (ABPBE) | 2024–present

Brazil

Member, Society of Addiction Psychology (APA Division 50) | 2024–present

USA

Member, American Psychological Association (APA) | 2021–present

USA

Member, International Network on Brief Interventions for Alcohol and Other Drugs (INEBRIA) | 2021–present

Latin America

Registered Clinical Psychologist (CRP-SP) | 2015–present

Federal Council of Psychology, Brazil

PUBLICATIONS AND DISSEMINATION

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- 1 **Donate, A.P.G.**, de Macedo, E.C., Bedendo, A., Félix Júnior, I., Gallo, G.G., Opaleye, E.S., et al. (2023). *The effect of mindfulness on decision-making, inhibitory control, and impulsivity of substance use disorder in-treatment patients: A randomized clinical trial*. PLoS ONE, 18(11), e0293502. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0293502>
- 2 Félix-Junior, I.J., Opaleye, E.S., **Donate, A.P.G.**, et al. (2023). *Effectiveness of Mindfulness for Anger Expression on Men in Treatment for Substance Use Disorders: a Randomized Controlled Trial*. International Journal of Mental Health and Addiction. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11469-023-01113-y>
- 3 Júnior, I.J.F., **Donate, A.P.G.**, Noto, A.R., Galduróz, J.C.F., Simionato, N.M., Opaleye, E.S. (2022). *Mindfulness-based Interventions in inpatient treatment for SUDs: a systematic review*. Addictive Behaviors Reports, 100467. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.abrep.2022.100467>
- 4 Gallo, G.G., Curado, D.F., Opaleye, E.S., **Donate, A.P.G.**, Scattone, V.V., Noto, A.R. (2020). *Impulsivity and Mindfulness among Inpatients with Alcohol Use Disorder*. Substance Use & Misuse, 55(1), 25–32. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10826084.2020.1833924>

- 5 Manfredi, M., Proverbio, A.M., **Donate, A.P.G.**, Macarini, S., Andreoli, M., Comfort, W.E., Boggio, P.S. (2017). *tDCS application over the STG improves the ability to recognize and appreciate elements involved in humor processing*. *Experimental Brain Research*, 235, 1843–1852. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s00221-017-4932-5>
- 6 **Donate, A.P.G.**, Marques, L.M., Lapenta, O.M., Atashana, M.K., Amodio, D., Boggio, P.S. (2017). *Ostracism via virtual chat room: Effects on basic needs, anger, and pain*. *PLoS ONE*, 12, 1–13. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0184215>

Book Chapters

- **Donate, A.P.G.**, Ramos, D.M.F., Rêgo, G.G., Boggio, P.S. (2016). *Feridas que Não Sangram [Non-bleeding wounds]*. In P.S. Boggio & E.C. de Macedo (Eds.), *Neurociências e Psicologia Aplicada [Neuroscience Applied to Daily Life]*. Hogrefe.

Invited Talks

- *The Challenges of Treatment for Substance Use Disorders* — Podcast: Nós entre Psis (2023)
- *Cognitive and Behavioral Therapy: What is the evidence, and how does it work?* — Public Ministry of São Paulo State (virtual, 2022)
- *Mindfulness and Impulsivity* — Mindfulness em Debate (virtual, 2022)
- *Emotion Regulation During the Pandemic* — Mindfulness em Debate (virtual, 2020)
- *Woman Empowerment* — Television Program (2017)

Conference Presentations (Oral)

- **Donate, A.P.G.**, Macedo, E.C., Opaleye, E.S., Noto, A.R. *Effects of Mindfulness on Impulsivity of People with Substance Use Disorders in Therapeutic Communities*. X Simpósio de Medicina e Sociologia do Abuso de Drogas, UNIFESP (2020).
- **Donate, A.P.G.**, Macedo, E.C., Opaleye, E.S., Noto, A.R. *Efeitos do MBRP na Impulsividade de Pessoas com Transtorno por Uso de Substâncias*. IX Simpósio de Medicina e Sociologia do Abuso de Drogas, UNIFESP (2019).
- **Donate, A.P.G.**, Macedo, E.C., Opaleye, E.S., Noto, A.R. *MBRP in a Therapeutic Community*. VIII Simpósio de Medicina e Sociologia do Abuso de Drogas, UNIFESP (2018).
- **Donate, A.P.G.**, Boggio, P.S. *Role of the Prefrontal Cortex on a Social Virtual Interaction Task*. Jornada de Iniciação Científica, Mackenzie University (2013).
- **Donate, A.P.G.**, Boggio, P.S. *Ostracism During Social Virtual Interaction – Behavioral Aspects*. Jornada de Iniciação Científica, Mackenzie University (2013).

Conference Presentations (Poster)

- **Donate, A.P.G.** *Frequency or High Severity? Untangling Cannabis Use, Motives, and Mental Health in Sleep Outcomes*. Brain Congress 2025, Fortaleza, Brazil (2024).
- **Donate, A.P.G.**, Júnior, I.J.F., Gallo, G.G., Coutinho, E.M., Opaleye, E.S., Noto, A.R. *Effects of MBRP on Impulsivity and Decision-Making for People with SUD: A RCT*. XII Simpósio Internacional de Neuromodulação, São Paulo (2021).
- **Donate, A.P.G.**, Marques, L.M., Lapenta, O.M., Atashana, M.K., Boggio, P.S. *Modulation of Humor and Basic Needs During Ostracism via tDCS*. Simpósio Internacional de Neuromodulação, São Paulo (2014).

- **Donate, A.P.G.**, Costa, A.P., Araújo, C.F., Ramos, D.M.F., Silva, D.S., Rosenberg, F., Garcia, L.F., Neumann, M.M. *Resocialization Process of Ex-Prisoners in São Paulo*. Psicologia: Ciência e Profissão Conference, São Paulo (2014).
- **Donate, A.P.G.**, Marques, L.M., Lapenta, O.M., Atashana, M.K., Boggio, P.S. *Ostracism During Virtual Social Interaction Modulates Basic Needs and Humor*. Congresso Brasileiro Psicologia: Ciência e Profissão, São Paulo (2014).

RELEVANT SKILLS

Clinical Training & Assessment

- Licensed CBT Therapist (2016)
- Mindfulness-Based Relapse Prevention Instructor
- Administration & scoring: WAIS, WISC, Five Digit Test (FDT), Wisconsin Card Sorting Test (WCST), Tower of Hanoi, Trail Making Test (TMT), D2 Test of Attention, Rey Auditory Verbal Learning Test (RAVLT)

EEG & Psychophysiology

- EEG (128 channels): set-up and data acquisition
- BIOPAC: EDA100C and ECG100C modules (set-up, acquisition, filtering, analysis)

Non-Invasive Brain Stimulation

- Transcranial Direct Current Stimulation (tDCS): set-up, data collection, analysis (10–20 system)

Statistical & Data Analysis

- Linear and Logistic Regression; ANOVA; Multilevel Models; Mediation & Moderation Analysis
- Software: R, SPSS, JASP, JAMOVI
- Advanced use of REDCap, Kubios, AcqKnowledge, E-Prime, Inquisit 5

Productivity & Reference Tools

- Microsoft Office; Canva
- EndNote; Mendeley Desktop

Languages

- Portuguese (Native)
- English (Advanced)
- Spanish (Basic)
- Danish (Basic)

COURSES

Methodology & Statistics

- Experience Sampling Methods (2025)
- Reproducible Science (2024)
- Introduction to R (2024)
- Intermediate Statistics using SPSS (2024)
- Statistics Applied in Psychobiology I & II (2020)
- Systematic Review as a Scientific Inquiry (2023)

Neuroscience & Neuromodulation

- Principles of Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation (TMS): Theory & Applications (2021)
- Cognition, Prefrontal/Frontal Function and Neuromodulation (2021)
- EEG and Neurofeedback Principles (2020)
- Summer School of Neuroscience (2016)
- XIII Summer School of Psychobiology (2013)
- Methods in Brain Stimulation in Clinical Practice (2011)

Clinical & Intervention Training

- Mindfulness-Based Relapse Prevention: Introductory (2017), Theoretical (2018), Advanced (2018)
- Mental Disorders – Neurobiology, Psychopathology, and Pharmacotherapy (2018)
- System for Detecting Abuse and Dependence on Psychoactive Substances (2017)
- VII Developmental Disorders Course (2011)

Professional Development & Ethics

- Project Management for PhD Students (2023)
- Responsible Conduct of Research (2023)
- Ethics in Scientific Research (2018)
- Using PubMed for Research (2018)

ORGANIZATION OF EVENTS AND COURSES

2024 – Summer School: Substance Use Disorders: Critical Views on Interventions and Recovery, Coordinator, Aarhus University (BSS).

2023 – Well-Being Conference for PhD Students, Coordinator, Aarhus University.

2018 – Mindfulness-Based Relapse Prevention Retreat, Assistant, Federal University of São Paulo.

2017 – Mindfulness-Based Relapse Prevention Retreat, Assistant, Federal University of São Paulo.

REFERENCES

Prof. Dr. Kristine Rømer (she/ her)

Centre for Alcohol and Drug Research,
Department of Psychology
Associate Professor at Aarhus University,
Denmark

Prof. Dr. Eméríta Satiro Opaleye (she/ her)

Vice-Director of NEPSIS
Tenured Researcher at the Federal
University of Sao Paulo, Brazil
emerita.satiro@unifesp.br

Prof. Dr. Ana Regina Noto (she/ her)

Founder and Director of NEPSIS
Professor at the Federal University of Sao
Paulo, Brazil
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Prof. Dr. Elizeu Coutinho de Macedo (he/ him)

Founder and Director SCANLab, Mackenzie
Presbyterian University, Brazil
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